3.12 Acute Respiratory Distress Syndrome (ARDS)

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Cannot speak in full sentences **Objective** • SpO_2 85% even on high-flow oxygen • Bilateral infiltrates on chest X-ray • Low PaO_2/FiO_2 ratio	**ACTUAL** **Impaired gas exchange** related to alveolar-capillary membrane damage as evidenced by refractory hypoxemia and bilateral infiltrates.	Reaches the prescribed SpO_2 or PaO_2 target on ventilatory support.	• Watch ABG, SpO_2 and the ventilator settings. • Assist with intubation and mechanical ventilation. • Use prone positioning according to protocol. • Keep PEEP as prescribed and avoid disconnecting the circuit unless necessary. • Give sedation as ordered.	Oxygenation on target: **goal met**.
Subjective • Family say he was very anxious **Objective** • Fluid balance 3 L positive • Crackles all through both lungs	**ACTUAL** **Excess fluid volume** related to increased capillary permeability as evidenced by positive balance and crackles.	Fluid balance neutral or negative, as ordered.	• Strict I&O and a daily weight. • Give diuretics as prescribed. • Follow a conservative fluid strategy as ordered.	Fluid balance on target: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • On a ventilator • Immobile • Lying prone	**RISK** **Risk for adult pressure injury** as evidenced by risk factors: immobility, sedation and prone positioning.	Skin and pressure areas stay intact while ventilated and proned.	• When prone, pad the face, chest, knees and any other pressure areas. • Move the head and arms as the prone protocol says. • Every shift, check the skin and the areas under devices (tube ties, masks). • Nurse him on a pressure-redistributing mattress.	Skin intact: **goal met**.